A diff is a risk report.

How I read every AI-assisted change — before it becomes tomorrow's incident.

10 slides · swipe

Anton Petnitsky · Python / agents / backend

A diff is not 'what the AI wrote'.

A diff is a map of where risk moved. It tells you which invariants changed, which assumptions moved, which call sites silently changed meaning.

**Read the diff as a threat model,
not as author credit.**

Anton Petnitsky · Python / agents / backend

The first five minutes with any diff.

01 Which invariant changed, if any?

02 What moved first — the side effect or the validation?

03 Who downstream sees the regression first?

04 Which boundary got crossed — and was that allowed?

05 Does the commit message still match reality?

AI-generated code fails fastest at the boundaries — find those lines first.

Anton Petnitsky · Python / agents / backend

Two ways to 'review' AI output.

PERFORMS	VERIFIES
Rubber stamp it compiles tests green merged in 40s	**Risk review** diff read twice invariants checked ownership understood

The second takes longer. Until the outage it saves.

Anton Petnitsky · Python / agents / backend

GIT · RED FLAGS · 5/10

The lines that deserve a second look.

01 Deleted error handling 'for cleanliness'

02 A silent default replacing a loud exception

03 A test suite edited to pass, not to assert

04 A commit that bundles unrelated cleanups

05 Config changes that favor the author's machine

One of these in ten diffs is an incident already scheduled.

Anton Petnitsky · Python / agents / backend

My diff review order.

01 Read the message — does it match the diff?



02 Scan for deleted safety — swallowed errors, relaxed limits



03 Trace one changed invariant end-to-end



04 Ask the AI to defend its own risky line — watch it backpedal

The AI is a junior dev with infinite stamina. Review like it.

Anton Petnitsky · Python / agents / backend

Why this matters more with AI in the loop.

More code, faster, less understood by anyone. The review gate is the only place where 'machine-generated' meets 'industry-accepted'. Make it real or it becomes theater.

**Velocity without review
is technical debt at scale.**

Why a good diff review team wins.

When everyone reviews like it's their own outage coming, the outage doesn't come.

Shared ownership of the diff = shared ownership of the incident.

Anton Petnitsky · Python / agents / backend

The review rule.

AI-generated code raises the value of review because it increases the amount of plausible-looking change. A clean 'AI wrote it, tests pass' commit is exactly the one to slow down on.

Plausible is not correct.
Review is the filter.

Anton Petnitsky · Python / agents / backend

GIT · KEEP THIS · 10/10

Save this for your next AI-assisted PR.

Next time an AI PR opens green, read the deletions before the additions. Save this checklist for that moment.

Save for later review

Anton Petnitsky · Python / agents / backend